

POLITICS

INTRODUCTION

Politics involves the study of how societies are governed, how public policy is developed, and how power is distributed. It also concerns how citizens take public action, working for the common good within communities at the local, national, and/or global level. Political inquiry involves the exploration of political concepts, processes, practices, issues, and trends, and the development of an understanding of the importance of political engagement and how and why the interests and perspectives of stakeholders may differ. Through such inquiry, students clarify and generate support for their own positions on a variety of issues. The study of politics also enables students to develop an understanding of their rights and responsibilities and to explore various elements of the citizenship education framework.

Strands

The Grade 11 politics course has four strands, while the Grade 12 politics course has five strands. In both courses, strand A, Political Inquiry and Skill Development, is followed by content strands, which are organized thematically.

Citizenship Education

The expectations in the Grade 11 and 12 politics courses provide opportunities for students to explore a number of concepts connected to the citizenship education framework (see page 13).

The Concepts of Political Thinking

The four concepts of political thinking – political significance, objectives and results, stability and change, and political perspective – underpin thinking and learning in all politics courses in the Canadian and world studies program. At least one concept of political thinking is identified as the focus for each overall expectation in the content strands of these courses. The following chart describes each concept and provides sample questions related to it. These questions highlight opportunities for students to apply a specific concept in their studies. (See page 16 for a fuller discussion of the concepts of disciplinary thinking.)

Political Significance
This concept requires students to determine the importance of things such as government policies; political or social issues, events, or developments; and the civic actions of individuals and groups. Political significance is generally determined by the impact of a government policy or decision on the lives of citizens, or by the influence that civic action, including the civic action of students, has on political or public decision making. Students develop their understanding that the political significance of something may vary for different groups of people. Related Questions* – Why is it important to understand how political structures and processes work? (CHV2O, Overview) – Why are some issues politically important while others tend to be ignored? (CPC3O, B2.1) – How would you determine the political significance of a government’s decision to call an early election? (CPW4U, A1.5) – Who are some theorists whose ideas are central to postcolonial political thought? What is the significance of their ideas? (CPW4U, B1.2)
Objectives and Results
This concept requires students to determine the factors that lead to events, policies, decisions, and/or plans of action of civic and political importance. It also requires students to analyse the effects of civic and political actions and to recognize that government policies and decisions as well as responses to civic issues can have a range of effects on various groups of people. A comparison of the initial purpose or goals of a policy or decision and its effects enables students to distinguish between intended and unintended results. Related Questions – What was the objective of the UN Declaration of Human Rights? Do all people enjoy the rights embodied in that document? (CHV2O, B3.4) – What are some examples of political actions or policies that have produced unintended results? (CPC3O, A1.5) – What problems were some provinces hoping to solve by adopting the harmonized sales tax (HST)? Did the adoption of the HST solve these problems? (CPC3O, B3.3) – What are some examples of the influence of Canada’s commitment to human rights and democratic values on its foreign policy? What are some examples of the influence of economic considerations on Canada’s foreign policy? (CPW4U, C3.2)

* The “related questions” are drawn directly from the overview charts that precede the Grade 11 and 12 politics courses and from the sample questions that accompany many specific expectations. To highlight the continuity between the politics courses in Grade 11 and 12 and the Grade 10 civics (politics) course, and to show possible development in the use of the concepts of political thinking over those grades, the chart includes some questions from the Grade 10 civics course as well.

Stability and Change

This concept requires students to analyse how and why political institutions and government policies change over time or why they remain the same. Students will determine how political structures and decisions contribute to stability and change within various local, national, and/or global communities. They analyse ways in which various institutions, groups, or individuals resist or support change, as well as how a variety of factors, including civic action, can contribute to change or stability. Students also apply this concept to help them determine when change is necessary and how they themselves can contribute to change, or help ensure stability, through civic action.

Related Questions

- What impact can consumers' choices have on the natural environment? (CHV2O, C1.3)
- Why are people concerned about growing economic inequality, both in Canada and globally? (CPC3O, B3.2)
- How have technological developments such as social media affected the strategies of groups seeking political change? (CPC3O, C3.2)
- How does decolonization continue to affect politics and international relations today? (CPW4U, Overview)

Political Perspective

This concept requires students to analyse the beliefs and values of various groups, including different governments, in local, national, and/or global communities. Students analyse how these beliefs and values, as well as political ideologies, can affect one's position on or response to issues of civic importance. Students also develop their awareness of how stakeholder groups with different perspectives can influence the policies and platforms of political parties and the decisions of governments.

Related Questions

- How important a role do you think the media play in swaying public opinion on social/political issues? Whose opinions do you think the media reflect? (CHV2O, B2.4)
- What facets of your personal identity affect your political orientation? (CPC3O, B1.1)
- How does the relationship of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit people with the environment influence their position on some political issues? (CPW4U, B3.6)
- Why might grassroots groups and transnational corporations have different perspectives on how food security should be addressed? (CPW4U, D2.1)

The Political Inquiry Process

In each course in politics in the Canadian and world studies curriculum, strand A focuses explicitly on the political inquiry process, guiding students in their investigation of political issues, events, developments, policies, decisions, concepts, and/or plans of action. This process is *not* intended to be applied in a linear manner: students will use the applicable components of the process in the order most appropriate for them and for the task at hand. Although strand A covers all of the components of the inquiry process, it is important to note that students apply skills associated with the inquiry process throughout the content strands in each course. (See page 32 for a fuller discussion of the inquiry process in the Canadian and world studies program.)

The following chart identifies ways in which students may approach each of the components of the political inquiry process.

Formulate Questions
Students formulate questions: – to explore various issues, developments, concepts, policies, decisions, and/or processes that are related to the overall expectations in order to identify the focus of their inquiry – to help them determine which key concept (or concepts) of political thinking is relevant to their inquiry – that reflect the selected concept(s) of political thinking – to develop criteria that they will use in evaluating policy, data, evidence, and/or information; in making judgements, decisions, or predictions; in reaching conclusions; in solving problems; and/or in formulating and/or evaluating plans of action
Gather and Organize
Students: – collect relevant qualitative and quantitative data, evidence, and/or information from a variety of primary and secondary sources,^a including visuals^b and community resources^c – determine if their sources are credible, accurate, and reliable – identify the purpose and intent of each source – identify the points of view in the sources they have gathered – use a variety of methods to organize the data, evidence, and/or information they have gathered – record the sources of the data, evidence, and/or information they are using – decide whether they have collected enough data, evidence, and/or information for their inquiry

a. Primary sources may include, but are not limited to, census data, interviews, legislation, letters, photographs, policy documents, speeches, and treaties. Secondary sources may include, but are not limited to, documentaries and other films, editorials, news articles, political cartoons, reference books, song lyrics, and works of art. Depending on the context, digital sources, including social media and websites, can be either primary or secondary sources.

b. Visuals may include, but are not limited to, photographs, media clips, maps, models, graphs, and diagrams.

c. Community resources may include, but are not limited to, a range of resources from community groups and associations, government offices, and non-governmental organizations.

Interpret and Analyse
Students: – analyse data, evidence, and/or information, applying the relevant concepts of political thinking (see preceding chart) – use different types of tools to help them interpret and analyse their data, evidence, and/or information – identify the key points or ideas in each source – interpret data and representations of data (e.g., graphs, charts, diagrams, statistical tables) to help them analyse issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions – construct graphs, charts, and/or diagrams to help them analyse the issue, event, development, policy, practices, and/or decision they are investigating and/or the plan of action they are developing – analyse their sources to determine the importance of an issue, event, development, plan of action, policy, practice, decision, and/or outcome for communities, individuals, and/or groups, including different groups – identify biases in individual sources – determine if all points of view are represented in the source materials as a whole, and which, if any, are missing
Evaluate and Draw Conclusions
Students: – synthesize data, evidence, and/or information, and make informed, critical judgements based on that data, evidence, and/or information – make connections between different factors and contexts when analysing issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions – determine the short- and long-term impact of issues, events, developments, policies, practices, and/or decisions on different individuals, communities, groups, and/or regions – assess the ethical implications of issues, policies, practices, decisions, and/or plans of action – reach conclusions about the subject of their inquiry, and support them with their data, evidence, and/or information – make predictions based on their data, evidence, and/or information – use criteria to determine appropriate forms of action and/or to evaluate the impact of a plan of action
Communicate
Students: – use appropriate forms (e.g., oral, visual, written, multimedia) for different audiences and purposes – communicate their arguments, conclusions, predictions, and/or plans of action clearly and logically – use terminology and concepts related to politics and citizenship education correctly and effectively – cite sources, using appropriate forms of documentation

Canadian and International Politics, Grade 12

University Preparation

CPW4U

This course explores various perspectives on issues in Canadian and world politics. Students will explore political decision making and ways in which individuals, stakeholder groups, and various institutions, including governments, multinational corporations, and non-governmental organizations, respond to and work to address domestic and international issues. Students will apply the concepts of political thinking and the political inquiry process to investigate issues, events, and developments of national and international political importance, and to develop and communicate informed opinions about them.

Prerequisite: Any university or university/college preparation course in Canadian and world studies, English, or social sciences and humanities

OVERVIEW

The course has five strands. Instruction and learning related to the expectations in strand A are to be interwoven with instruction and learning related to expectations from the other four strands. Strand A must not be seen as independent of the other strands. Student achievement of the expectations in strand A is to be assessed and evaluated *throughout* the course.

Strand A

A. Political Inquiry and Skill Development
Overall Expectations
A1. Political Inquiry: use the political inquiry process and the concepts of political thinking when investigating issues, events, and developments of national and international political importance
A2. Developing Transferable Skills: apply in everyday contexts skills developed through investigations related to politics, and identify various careers in which a background in political studies might be an asset

(continued)

Overview *(continued)*

Throughout this course, when planning instruction, teachers should weave the expectations from strand A in with the expectations from strands B–E.

Strands B–E

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Political Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
B. Political Foundations		
B1. Political Thought: demonstrate an understanding of various political ideologies, theories, and concepts, and analyse their relevance to Canadian and international politics (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	Political thinking reflects social, economic, and technological changes and affects political policy.	What criteria would you use to assess political thinkers? Whose voices are represented, and whose voices are not, in traditional political theory?
B2. The Evolution of Modern Politics and International Relations: analyse the role of ideology, diplomacy, and conflict, including conflict related to decolonization, in the evolution of politics in and relations between various countries around the world in the past century (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Stability and Change</i>)	The past century has been marked by extensive political conflict but also by cooperation and diplomacy.	Under what circumstances can diplomacy work? How does decolonization continue to affect politics and international relations today?
B3. Influences on Canadian and International Politics: analyse how social, economic, and geographic factors influence contemporary politics in and relations between various countries around the world (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Political Perspective</i>)	Relations between countries are affected by various economic, social, cultural, and environmental factors.	How do political/cultural values and identity affect relations within and between countries?
C. Governments and Canadian and International Politics		
C1. The International Influence of Governments: analyse how strategies/practices used by a state or states can affect the policies and status of other states (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Objectives and Results</i>)	Individual nations use various means to influence the policies and/or status of other nations.	What are the benefits and disadvantages to Canada of being a member of international and intergovernmental organizations?
C2. Intergovernmental Cooperation: demonstrate an understanding of the role of intergovernmental cooperation in international politics (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Stability and Change</i>)	Canada's participation in international organizations has changed over time. Technological advances create new reasons for intergovernmental cooperation.	How and why does Canada exert political pressure on other nations? Is Canada an important world player?
C3. Canadian Government Policies and International Relations: analyse Canada's foreign policy objectives and factors that affect them (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Political Perspective</i>)	Canada's foreign policy objectives and actions are influenced by political, economic, and cultural considerations.	Are Canadian values about democratic and human rights reflected in our foreign policy?

* See page 17 for a discussion of the purpose of big ideas and framing questions.

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Political Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
D. Non-governmental Action on Canadian and International Political Issues		
D1. Civic Awareness and Responsibility: analyse the role of civic awareness and responsibility among citizens and non-governmental stakeholders in the national and international community (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Political Perspective</i>)	Informed and responsible citizens can make a difference in the local, national, and global community.	What are the attributes of a responsible global citizen? How has technology affected political participation?
D2. Challenges and Strategies: demonstrate an understanding of key challenges relating to various issues of national and global political importance and of the strategies and effectiveness of various non-governmental stakeholders, including NGOs, in addressing them (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Political Perspective</i>)	There are many forms of political activism and civic engagement.	Is civil disobedience ever justified? How does one measure the effectiveness of a non-governmental organization or social enterprise group?
D3. Contributions to the Global Community: assess the importance of the contributions of individuals and other non-governmental stakeholders to national and global communities (FOCUS ON: <i>Objectives and Results; Stability and Change</i>)	The global community has benefited in many ways from the actions of individuals and groups.	
E. Rights and Power in the International Community		
E1. Influence, Power, and Decision Making: demonstrate an understanding of how power is distributed and exercised in Canada and other countries, and of factors that affect its distribution (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Objectives and Results</i>)	Geographic, demographic, economic, political, and military factors all affect the global balance of power.	What makes a nation politically powerful? Why are some countries more powerful than others? How is Canada's democratic system of government different from systems in other countries?
E2. Technology and Globalization: assess the influence of globalization and technology on Canadian and international politics (FOCUS ON: <i>Stability and Change; Political Perspective</i>)	Communications and information technology has had an impact on political action and processes in Canada and worldwide. Globalization has affected political, cultural, and economic boundaries.	Has globalization harmed or benefited Canada? Would the answer be the same for all Canadians? How and why do multinational enterprises hold political as well as economic power?
E3. Human Rights at Home and Abroad: explain violations of human rights in Canada and abroad as well as the role of Canadian and international laws, institutions, and processes in the protection of human rights (FOCUS ON: <i>Political Significance; Stability and Change</i>)	There have been human rights abuses in many countries, including Canada. Many governments and other institutions work in defence of human rights.	Should the Canadian government defend human rights beyond its borders? Why do human rights abuses still exist?

A. POLITICAL INQUIRY AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Political Inquiry:** use the political inquiry process and the concepts of political thinking when investigating issues, events, and developments of national and international political importance;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills developed through investigations related to politics, and identify various careers in which a background in political studies might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Political Inquiry

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into issues, events, and/or developments of national and international political importance (e.g., factual questions: *Which ideologies are on the extremes on the political spectrum?*; comparative questions: *What are the main similarities and differences between the structures of government in Canada and Great Britain?*; causal questions: *What impact did the 9/11 attacks have on domestic political policy in the United States?*)
- A1.2** select and organize relevant evidence, data, and information about issues, events, and/or developments of national and international political importance from a variety of primary and secondary sources (e.g., primary: *interviews, legislation, photographs, policy statements, speeches, statistics, surveys, treaties and other international agreements*; secondary: *articles, documentaries and other films, news stories, political cartoons, textbooks, websites*), ensuring that their sources reflect multiple perspectives
Sample questions: “Which government documents might be relevant to this issue? Where might you find them? What other sources might you use to supplement these documents?” “Which type of information might you find on the websites of groups or institutions that are lobbying governments on or otherwise addressing this issue?” “How can you ensure that your sources reflect a variety of perspectives?”
- A1.3** assess the credibility of sources relevant to their investigations (e.g., *the reliability of the evidence presented in a source; the purpose, intended audience, and context of a source; the bias, values, and expertise of the speaker/author*)
Sample questions: “What information do you need to help you determine which sources are most credible?” “What types of biases can be easily detected in a source? What types of biases might be more difficult to detect?” “Whose voice is reflected in this source? Whose voices have been omitted or misrepresented? What are the implications of the omission of these voices?”
- A1.4** interpret and analyse evidence, data, and information relevant to their investigations, using various tools, strategies, and approaches that are appropriate for political inquiry (e.g., *use a cross-classification chart to help them analyse information they have gathered about different countries’ responses to the same issue; use a web chart when comparing the points of view of different politicians; assess the validity and rank the importance of various points made in their sources; discuss, clarify, and compare positions on an issue with their peers*)
Sample questions: “What criteria might you use to rank the significance of the impact of a change in political policy? How might the ranking change if you adopted different criteria?”
- A1.5** use the concepts of political thinking (i.e., political significance, objectives and results, stability and change, political perspective) when analysing and evaluating evidence, data, and

information and formulating conclusions and/or judgements about issues, events, and/or developments of national and international political importance (e.g., *apply the concept of political significance when analysing the impact of a nationalist movement in a particular country; use the concept of objectives and results to help them determine the criteria to use in measuring the effectiveness of the work of a non-governmental organization; use the concept of stability and change when analysing the evolution of Canadian foreign policy; use the concept of political perspective to help them explain government support or lack of support for a particular United Nations resolution*)

Sample questions: “Why might it be appropriate to analyse this issue from human rights, economic, and environmental perspectives? Are there other perspectives you might also consider?” “How would you determine the political significance of a government’s decision to call an early election?” “What are some of the objectives of political polling? How might public opinion polls lead to unintended election results?” “Are democratic governments more or less stable than dictatorships? If not, why? If so, in what way?”

- A1.6** evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements or predictions about the issues, events, and/or developments they are investigating

Sample questions: “Did your findings challenge your initial assumptions about the topic? If so, in what way?” “When you review your research, which facts and arguments do you consider most persuasive? How have they affected the conclusion you have reached?” “What were the key ethical questions raised in the debate on this issue?” “Did the results of your inquiry influence your political perspective on the issue?”

- A1.7** communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the intended audience and purpose (e.g., *a persuasive essay on an issue related to globalization; a debate on the pros and cons of nationalism; a seminar on the relationship between political ideology and political policy; a letter to an appropriate elected official requesting action on an issue of national or international importance; a web page highlighting issues of importance to indigenous peoples; a blog about human rights*

issues; an editorial cartoon on a recent political controversy; a news report on a political protest in a country other than Canada)

- A1.8** use accepted forms of documentation (e.g., *footnotes or endnotes, author/date citations, bibliographies, reference lists*) to reference different types of sources (e.g., *articles, blogs, books, films or videos, policies, websites*)

- A1.9** use appropriate terminology when communicating the results of their investigations (e.g., *vocabulary specific to the topic; terms related to political studies and the concepts of political thinking*)

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** describe ways in which political inquiry can help them develop skills, including the essential skills in the Ontario Skills Passport (e.g., *skills related to reading texts, writing, document use, computer use, oral communication, numeracy, decision making, problem solving*), and those related to the citizenship education framework,* that can be transferred to postsecondary opportunities, the world of work, and everyday life

- A2.2** demonstrate in everyday contexts attributes, skills, and work habits developed through investigations into political issues, events, and/or developments (e.g., *show attributes such as respect and cooperation to help them build positive relationships with diverse individuals/groups; use critical-thinking and decision-making skills to formulate a position on a controversial issue and participate in informed discussions/debates about that issue; apply work habits such as initiative and responsibility when researching and considering their postsecondary options*)

Sample questions: “What are the most appropriate ways to demonstrate questioning skills when people are voicing their position on an issue?” “How do your own biases affect your line of questioning and your understanding of other people’s responses?”

- A2.3** apply the concepts of political thinking when analysing current events relating to issues of national and international political importance (e.g., *a coup d’état, a political protest*

* The citizenship education framework appears on page 13.

and the government response, a terrorist attack, the mistreatment of Canadian nationals in another country, a new international trade agreement, a break in diplomatic relations between two states), in order to enhance their understanding of these issues and their role as informed citizens

Sample questions: “What political perspectives are different political parties taking on this issue?” “Are there other people affected by this issue who are not represented in this news story?” “What is the political significance of the 2013 Federal Court ruling that Métis people in Canada have the same status as ‘status Indians’?”

A2.4 identify a variety of careers in which skills developed in political studies might be an asset (*e.g., band councillor, community leader/activist, educator, international aid worker, journalist, lawyer, lobbyist for a non-governmental organization, policy analyst, politician, pollster, researcher, social worker, speech writer*)

B. POLITICAL FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course students will:

- B1. Political Thought:** demonstrate an understanding of various political ideologies, theories, and concepts, and analyse their relevance to Canadian and international politics (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)
- B2. The Evolution of Modern Politics and International Relations:** analyse the role of ideology, diplomacy, and conflict, including conflict related to decolonization, in the evolution of politics in and relations between various countries around the world in the past century (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Stability and Change*)
- B3. Influences on Canadian and International Politics:** analyse how social, economic, and geographic factors influence contemporary politics in and relations between various countries around the world (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Political Thought

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course students will:

- B1.1** describe some key similarities and differences between various political ideologies (*e.g., liberalism, conservatism, capitalism, fascism, socialism, communism, anarchism*), and explain where these ideologies fall on a political spectrum (*i.e., a political compass model or other type of spectrum*)

Sample questions: “What are some political spectrum models? Which do you find to be most useful? Why?” “If communism and Nazism are both associated with totalitarian regimes, why are they situated at opposite ends of a left-right political spectrum?” “Where do ‘green’ political ideologies fit on political spectrum models?”

- B1.2** describe the main ideas of various political theorists/philosophers (*e.g., John Locke, Thomas Hobbes, Jean-Jacques Rousseau, Mary Wollstonecraft, John Stuart Mill, Karl Marx, Hannah Arendt, Frantz Fanon*), and explain ways in which these ideas have influenced historical and/or contemporary politics (*e.g., with reference to the political rights of women, the establishment of communist or socialist states, decolonization, the welfare state, the neoliberal policies of Margaret Thatcher or Ronald Reagan*)

Sample questions: “Why is Plato considered a great political thinker? In what ways are his ideas still relevant to present-day political debates?” “Who are some theorists whose ideas are central to postcolonial political thought? What is the significance of their ideas?” “What do different political theorists argue is the ideal level of government involvement in business and the economy?”

- B1.3** analyse the concept of nationalism (*e.g., with reference to sovereignty, patriotism, ethnic nationalism, national identity, national pride, different concepts of nationhood*) and how nationalism and nationalist ideologies have affected and continue to affect politics in Canada and other countries (*e.g., political unification and/or separation of some countries, nationalist/separatist movements, the role of nationalism in anticolonial movements, ethnic cleansing, nationalist symbols and images, jingoism, militarism*)

Sample questions: “Why are there different ideas about what constitutes a nation?” “What is the significance of separatist movements in Canada and other nations?” “How can patriotic assertiveness affect a nation domestically and in its international relations?”

B2. The Evolution of Modern Politics and International Relations

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Stability and Change*

By the end of this course students will:

B2.1 analyse key policies of some governments, both historical and contemporary, in various regions, and identify the political approaches/ideologies these policies reflect (e.g., liberalism, conservatism, neoliberalism, social democracy, socialism, communism, fascism, Nazism, communism, populism)

Sample questions: “In what ways did Germany’s Nuremberg Laws reflect Nazi ideology?” “How would you account for the fact that medicare in Canada was born in Saskatchewan and not another province?” “What differences do you note in Canadian trade policies of the governments of Jean Chrétien and Stephen Harper? What do these differences tell you about the political ideologies of these governments?” “What political approaches/ideologies are reflected in Canadian and provincial policies towards First Nations, Inuit, and Métis people?”

B2.2 analyse ways in which conflict and violence have influenced politics in and relations between various countries around the world since World War I (e.g., civil wars in Russia, Spain, Algeria, China, or Syria; Axis invasions during World War II; genocides, ethnic cleansing, and other crimes against humanity in Turkey, Nazi Germany, Ukraine, Rwanda, or the former Yugoslavia; terrorism in Northern Ireland or the Middle East; the Dirty War in Argentina; the crushing of the Prague Spring or Arab Spring)

Sample questions: “What are some ways in which the Cold War influenced domestic political policy in countries on both sides of the Iron Curtain? How did it affect international relations?” “What impact did apartheid policies in South Africa have on that country’s relations with other countries in the international community?” “What are some key ways in which the 9/11 terrorist attacks changed global politics?”

B2.3 analyse the role of some pivotal developments in diplomacy since the late nineteenth century (e.g., the Peace Congress of 1899 in The Hague, the Treaty of Versailles, the League of Nations, the Munich Agreement, the United Nations [UN], Strategic Arms Limitation Talks, the Camp David Accord)

Sample questions: “What key international events and agreements can be seen as precursors to the formation of the UN?” “What do you

think are the greatest accomplishments in diplomacy in the past century? What do you think are the greatest failures? Why?”

B2.4 describe key developments related to decolonization and how they have affected politics in and relations between various countries since World War II (e.g., wars of liberation and civil wars, creation of new states in former colonies, changing borders, new political alliances, power struggles in newly independent countries, establishment of the Commonwealth, replacement of political colonization with economic colonization, changes in trade)

Sample questions: “What types of conflicts preceded and accompanied the independence of India? How are those conflicts still relevant today?” “What impact has decolonization had on the function and priorities of the United Nations?” “What impact does decolonization continue to have in Libya, Rwanda, and/or Senegal?”

B3. Influences on Canadian and International Politics

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course students will:

B3.1 analyse how various economic factors (e.g., GDP per capita, trade balances, poverty rates, currency exchange rates, employment rates, inflation rates, recessions, depressions) influence politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada

Sample questions: “What are some characteristics of the Canadian economy that affect its power internationally?” “How has the fiscal crisis experienced by several European Union (EU) member countries affected international politics?” “How can foreign debt affect the domestic and/or foreign policy of a country?”

B3.2 analyse various ways in which national, ethnic, and/or regional identities influence politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada (e.g., Mohawk protests at Oka and/or Anishinaabe protests at Ipperwash, the October Crisis, the Canadian policy of multiculturalism, regional political parties in Canada or other countries, the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, the Indo-Pakistani conflict, Somalia’s civil war, relations between Russia and Ukraine, organizations such as La Francophonie)

Sample questions: “What commonalities are there between the objectives of the Quebec sovereignist, Scottish nationalist, and Basque separatist movements?” “How have First Nations

beliefs in the right to self-determination with respect to governance, land, and resources influenced Canadian politics?" "What impact did ethnic rivalries have on the disintegration of the former Yugoslavia? What impact did the conflict between these groups have on other countries?"

B3.3 analyse how various social and cultural factors, including aspects of social/cultural identity, influence politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada (*e.g., with reference to shared language/culture, education levels and literacy rates, fertility rates, health and welfare, immigration, international sporting events*)

Sample questions: "How and why might immigration influence political policies in a country and/or its relations with other countries?" "How has the AIDS pandemic affected domestic and foreign policy in some countries?" "Why might a country bid to host the Olympics or the Pan-American Games? What impact can such events have on international relations?"

B3.4 analyse various ways in which domestic political policies influence a country's relations with other countries (*e.g., with reference to apartheid, political persecution, or other human rights abuses; militarism and expansionism; economic protectionism or openness to free trade; relations between countries with different political outlooks*)

Sample questions: "What impact do domestic politics in the United States and Cuba have on relations between those two countries?" "What impact has nuclear testing by North Korea had on its relations with other countries?" "What impact does Canada's policy with respect to the Northwest Passage have on its relations with other countries?"

B3.5 analyse how religion influences politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada (*e.g., with reference to the public funding of secular and religious schools, ideas about the separation of church and state, the Islamic Revolution in Iran, the influence of religious teaching about gender roles, the role of religious fundamentalism in conflicts around the world*)

Sample questions: "How do religious differences between Muslim Sunni and Shia sects affect politics within and between countries?" "What are some ways in which religious affiliations/identities can influence politics, even in an officially secular state?" "What is a theocracy? What impact can the religious affiliation of a theocracy have on its political policies?"

B3.6 analyse how geographic and environmental factors influence politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada (*e.g., with reference to geographic location, natural resources, water scarcity, climate change, environmental degradation, natural disasters, invasive species*)

Sample questions: "How does the relationship of First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit people with the environment influence their position on some political issues?" "What are the objectives of the Kyoto Protocol? What are its limitations? Why has Canada withdrawn from the protocol? What impact do you think this will have?" "What are some ways in which countries' need for oil and gas affects international relations?"

C. GOVERNMENTS AND CANADIAN AND INTERNATIONAL POLITICS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. The International Influence of Governments:** analyse how strategies/practices used by a state or states can affect the policies and status of other states (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Objectives and Results*)
- C2. Intergovernmental Cooperation:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of intergovernmental cooperation in international politics (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*)
- C3. Canadian Government Policies and International Relations:** analyse Canada's foreign policy objectives and factors that affect them (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. The International Influence of Governments

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Objectives and Results*

By the end of this course students will:

- C1.1** explain, with reference to specific examples, the significance of diplomatic recognition for states and factors that can prevent countries from granting such recognition (*e.g., with reference to Taiwan and the People's Republic of China, South Ossetia, Palestine, Israel, recognition of a new government following a revolution or coup d'état*)

Sample questions: "In addition to having a population and a territory, what criteria are generally thought to be necessary for a political entity to be officially defined and recognized as a state? Are there different views about which criteria are essential?" "How might diplomatic recognition or the lack of it affect the economic activity of a particular territory or region?" "Does the recognition of a country's political leadership by the country's own people guarantee that the country will be internationally recognized? If not, why not?"

- C1.2** explain the significance of different classifications that are used to describe political entities in the international political system

(*e.g., political classifications such as country, state, territory, department, administrative region; economic classifications such as developed/developing, First World/Third World, North/South*)

Sample questions: "Which classification most effectively captures the similarities and differences among political entities? Why might a political entity object to being classified in a particular way?" "Do you think that common economic classifications of the countries of the world are accurate or meaningful? Why or why not?"

- C1.3** identify strategies used by individual countries or groups of countries to influence the internal policies of others in the international community (*e.g., sanctions, suspending diplomatic relations, motions of censure, granting or withdrawing aid, conferences, covert activities*), and assess their effectiveness in specific cases

Sample questions: "Why did Canadian prime minister Brian Mulroney implement economic sanctions against apartheid South Africa? Did all countries in the international community agree with this strategy? How effective do you think this strategy was?" "What are some ways in which the American Central Intelligence Agency has tried to influence the internal politics of some countries?" "How effective do you think votes of censure in the UN are in bringing about changes in policy in targeted countries?"

C1.4 explain how various forms of dispute resolution (*e.g., negotiations, mediation, arbitration, prosecution, International Court of Justice, sanctions, embargoes, war*) are used to resolve conflicts between states, and assess their effectiveness in specific cases

Sample questions: “What are some examples of the use of economic sanctions to address international conflicts? What were the objectives of the sanctions? To what extent did the use of sanctions achieve those objectives?” “What are some examples of disputes that have been brought to the International Court of Justice? Are the court’s rulings always accepted by the countries involved? If not, what provisions are in place to enforce them? How effective are these provisions?”

C2. Intergovernmental Cooperation

FOCUS ON: Objectives and Results; Stability and Change

By the end of this course students will:

C2.1 analyse the roles of various intergovernmental organizations (IGOs) as well as Canada’s role in them (*e.g., the UN, EU, African Union, World Health Organization, International Monetary Fund [IMF], World Trade Organization [WTO], Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries, Association of South Asian Nations*)

Sample questions: “Why do countries participate in IGOs?” “What is the role of the IMF and WTO? What are some ways in which these groups affect domestic political/economic policy in some countries?” “What are some IGOs in which Canada participates? Has Canada’s role in such organizations changed over time?” “What might be the effect of Canada’s choosing not to participate in some IGOs?”

C2.2 assess the effect on Canadians and the international community of various international agreements signed by Canada (*e.g., North American Free Trade Agreement [NAFTA], Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty, United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, Anti-Personnel Mine Ban Convention, Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species*)

Sample questions: “What are some issues of interest to Canada that can be addressed only by a formal international agreement?” “How do you think the signing of a freer trade agreement with the EU will affect Canadians? How might the signing of a freer trade agreement with Pacific Rim nations affect people living

in those regions and in Canada? Why might people hold different positions on whether to enter into such agreements?”

C2.3 analyse how globalization and technological advances have created the need for new types of intergovernmental cooperation (*e.g., with reference to nuclear weaponry; space exploration/activity; environmental and labour regulation in industrializing countries; censorship, freedom of speech, and the Internet; international terrorism; drug trafficking*), and explain what types of international organizations/agreements are being developed to address these changes

Sample questions: “What are some barriers to establishing a fair, balanced, and equitable environment for international trade? What IGOs provide a forum for debating and negotiating international trade agreements?” “What IGOs deal with preventing the proliferation and use of nuclear weapons? What are some of their achievements? What are some areas in which they have been unsuccessful?”

C3. Canadian Government Policies and International Relations

FOCUS ON: Objectives and Results; Political Perspective

By the end of this course students will:

C3.1 describe Canada’s foreign policy objectives and assess the effectiveness of the Department of Foreign Affairs, Trade and Development (DFATD) in achieving them

Sample questions: “Why did Ottawa fold the Canadian International Development Agency into DFATD?” “What are the implications of Canada’s losing its 2010 bid for a seat on the UN Security Council?”

C3.2 explain how various factors (*e.g., commitments under existing treaties, domestic interest groups, international non-governmental organizations [NGOs], foreign governments, the political perspective of the party in power, the health of the Canadian economy*) influence Canada’s foreign policy objectives and actions

Sample questions: “What are some examples of the influence of Canada’s commitment to human rights and democratic values on its foreign policy?” “What are some examples of the influence of economic considerations on Canada’s foreign policy?”

D. NON-GOVERNMENTAL ACTION ON CANADIAN AND INTERNATIONAL POLITICAL ISSUES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course students will:

- D1. Civic Awareness and Responsibility:** analyse the role of civic awareness and responsibility among citizens and non-governmental stakeholders in the national and international community (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Political Perspective*)
- D2. Challenges and Strategies:** demonstrate an understanding of key challenges relating to various issues of national and global political importance and of the strategies and effectiveness of various non-governmental stakeholders, including NGOs, in addressing them (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*)
- D3. Contributions to the Global Community:** assess the importance of the contributions of individuals and other non-governmental stakeholders to national and global communities (**FOCUS ON:** *Objectives and Results; Stability and Change*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Civic Awareness and Responsibility

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** analyse the role of responsible citizenship in the local, national, and global community

Sample questions: “What are some skills and attitudes listed in the citizenship education framework (see page 13) that an individual who seeks to be a responsible global citizen should develop?” “What do you consider to be the role of the responsible citizen in the global community? In what ways is this role similar to or different from the role of the responsible citizen in the local community?”

- D1.2** analyse the role of information technology and the media, including social media, in raising civic awareness of issues of national and global political importance

Sample questions: “What role does awareness of current events play in responsible citizenship?” “Why do some countries try to control the information available to their people? How can such control affect people’s civic participation?” “What impact do personal communication

devices have on the availability of information on global issues? In what ways is the information from these sources different than that from more traditional media sources? What are some ways in which the use of personal communication devices has affected public responses to political developments or issues?”

D2. Challenges and Strategies

FOCUS ON: *Objectives and Results; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course students will:

- D2.1** explain key challenges relating to some specific issues of national and global political importance (*e.g., Aboriginal land claims, climate change, protection of endangered species, loss of rainforest, food and water security, refugee crises, use of child soldiers or child labour, human trafficking, unfair trading practices, drug trafficking, violence against women, abuse of political power, privacy issues*)

Sample questions: “What are some factors that contribute to food insecurity? Do you think current policies effectively address these factors? If not, what limits the effectiveness of policy in this area? Why might grassroots groups

and transnational corporations have different perspectives on how food security should be addressed? Do you think the relative power of these stakeholders has an impact on policy on this issue?" "What are some ways in which racist, sexist, and/or classist attitudes and practices present challenges to addressing issues of political importance?" "Why do people respond differently to sudden, large-scale disasters than they do to ongoing global issues such as famine and climate change?"

D2.2 analyse various strategies used by individuals and non-governmental stakeholder groups to address issues of national or global importance and/or influence domestic or international decision-making processes

Sample questions: "What are some key strategies that NGOs use to achieve their objectives? What factors might affect their choice of strategy?" "What are some avenues through which individuals and stakeholder groups can influence government policy and/or decision making in national and global communities?" "Why might a group adopt terrorism as a strategy?"

D2.3 analyse lawful and unlawful forms of political activism or civic engagement, and assess responses to such activism

Sample questions: "Why might a form of protest or activism that is permitted in one country be unlawful elsewhere? Who are some individuals who have been arrested or persecuted for political activism in their own countries but who are celebrated for their actions elsewhere in the world?" "Do you think it is ever justifiable to break the law to advocate for change? If so, what criteria would you use to determine when it is justifiable?" "What are some ways in which governments in Canada have responded to unlawful political activism?"

D2.4 analyse how the perspectives of individuals and non-governmental stakeholder groups (e.g., corporations; unions; environmental, social justice, or women's groups; religious organizations; political lobby groups) may influence their response to issues of national and/or international political importance

Sample questions: "Why might a union and a corporation have different perspectives on a labour issue? How might these stakeholders differ in the ways they choose to respond to the issue?" "How important is it to be aware of the political or ideological perspective or agenda that an NGO, interest group, or social enterprise organization might have? If an organization is doing good work, does its ideology matter?

Why or why not?" "Why might Aboriginal people in Canada be sceptical of a lands claim process created by non-Aboriginal lawyers and policy strategists?"

D2.5 analyse, and assess the effectiveness of, the operations of various NGOs and social enterprise groups (e.g., in terms of their fundraising, organizational structures, strategies for carrying out their mandate)

Sample questions: "What criteria do you think are most important in measuring the operational effectiveness of an NGO?" "Does this organization have an advisory board that includes individuals from the region it is targeting?" "What criteria would you use to assess whether a non-profit group or charity deserves your money and/or your time as a volunteer?"

D3. Contributions to the Global Community

FOCUS ON: Objectives and Results; Stability and Change

By the end of this course students will:

D3.1 assess the importance of the contributions to Canada and the global community of various individuals (e.g., Louise Arbour, Stephen Lewis, Nelson Mandela, Rigoberta Menchu, Lester B. Pearson, Vandana Shiva, David Suzuki, Bertha von Suttner, Malala Yousafzai, Muhammad Yunus)

Sample questions: "What are some criteria you might use to determine the importance of a person's contribution?" "What are some examples of contributions that were intended primarily to benefit a specific group but that have also contributed to the common good?" "What are some of the characteristics of people who take on leadership roles on global issues?"

D3.2 describe the objectives of a variety of NGOs and social enterprise groups (e.g., Amnesty International, Democracy Watch, Free the Children, the International Campaign to Ban Landmines, Oxfam, the Red Cross / Red Crescent Societies, Right to Play, the Social Enterprise Council of Canada, World Wildlife Fund), and assess the importance of their contribution to the national and global community

Sample questions: "What are some Canadian NGOs that have made a significant contribution to the international community? How would you measure their effectiveness?" "Which NGOs do you think do the most important work in the international community? What are your reasons for choosing these organizations?"

E. RIGHTS AND POWER IN THE INTERNATIONAL COMMUNITY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Influence, Power, and Decision Making:** demonstrate an understanding of how power is distributed and exercised in Canada and other countries, and of factors that affect its distribution (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Objectives and Results*)
- E2. Technology and Globalization:** assess the influence of globalization and technology on Canadian and international politics (**FOCUS ON:** *Stability and Change; Political Perspective*)
- E3. Human Rights at Home and Abroad:** explain violations of human rights in Canada and abroad as well as the role of Canadian and international laws, institutions, and processes in the protection of human rights (**FOCUS ON:** *Political Significance; Stability and Change*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Influence, Power, and Decision Making

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Objectives and Results*

By the end of this course students will:

- E1.1** analyse the effect of various factors (*e.g., geography, demography, economic resources, military strength*) on the power of individual states and the global balance of power
Sample questions: “What criteria should be considered when measuring the power of a political entity?” “In what ways has the role of the United States as a global superpower changed? What factors have contributed to those changes?” “Which countries in the world are perceived to have the most power? How might perceived power influence actual power?” “What impact does the possession of nuclear weapons have on a state’s power or perceived power and the global balance of power?”
- E1.2** analyse how power is distributed in Canada and in various countries around the world (*e.g., with reference to social, economic, political, judicial, military power*)
Sample questions: “What is the relationship between economic and political power in Canada? Is the relationship similar or different in other countries?” “What are some states in

which the military plays a large role in politics? What are the political implications of this role?” “What are some benefits of a political structure that is based on a system of checks and balances? What are some drawbacks to such a structure?”

- E1.3** explain some key similarities and differences between Canada’s system of government and that of other countries (*e.g., Canada’s constitutional monarchy versus Iran’s theocracy, Brunei’s absolute monarchy, the U.S. republic, or Cuba’s one-party state; Canada’s federal state versus unitary states; powers held by the central government and other levels of government in Canada and elsewhere; who has and does not have the right to vote in Canada and elsewhere*)

Sample questions: “What are some key similarities and differences between Canada’s system of government and those of Britain and the United States?” “Do you think Canada has closer relations with countries that have systems of government similar to our own?”

- E1.4** explain the requirements for a democracy, and describe the characteristics and the strengths and weaknesses of different types of electoral systems used in democratic states (*e.g., single-member plurality, proportional representation, run-off systems*)

Sample questions: “What constitutes a democracy? Can a state be considered democratic if it places limitations on who can vote?” “Under

what circumstances, if any, do you think it is appropriate for a democratic state to place limits on free speech or a free press?" "Why are some groups trying to introduce proportional representation to Canadian electoral politics?"

- E1.5** identify countries or groups of countries that have supranational power, and analyse how such power affects international politics (*e.g., with reference to superpowers such as the United States, Russia, and China; regional institutions/agreements such as the EU, Arab League, Pan-African Parliament, Association of Southeast Asian Nations, Union of South American Nations, NAFTA*)

Sample questions: "What are some reasons why neighbouring countries form regional alliances? Do you think these alliances are generally effective? Why or why not?" "What countries might participate in future alliances and with what objectives?"

E2. Technology and Globalization

FOCUS ON: *Stability and Change; Political Perspective*

By the end of this course students will:

- E2.1** assess the influence of communications and information technologies, including social media, on politics in Canada and other countries (*e.g., with reference to increasing difficulty of controlling public access to previously privileged information; the use of robocalling to influence voters, of blogs to criticize governments, of texting to share information, of crowdsourcing to address a problem, of social media to follow, communicate with, and comment on politicians; ease of spreading propaganda or disinformation; the need for measures to protect privacy/confidential information*)

Sample questions: "What are some ways in which communications technology can be used to facilitate the electoral process? What are some ways in which it can be used to subvert the process?" "What are some benefits and drawbacks of online voting?" "How has the rise of social media influenced global awareness of government processes and/or the authority of governments? Is this a positive change? Why or why not?" "What role did social media play in the Egyptian revolution?"

- E2.2** analyse how globalization has affected politics in and relations between various countries, including Canada

Sample questions: "What are some ways in which globalization affects political and cultural boundaries?" "What are some negative effects

of globalization? Apart from a policy of isolationism, what strategies are available to governments to mitigate such effects?" "What are some ways in which globalization has benefited Canadians? Are there some groups that have benefited more than others? If so, why? Which groups in Canada have been hurt by globalization?"

- E2.3** analyse the impact of the power of multinational enterprises (MNEs) (*e.g., petrochemical, biotechnology, agribusiness, banking, media, clothing, automotive, computer, information technology, and/or mining companies*) on political policy in and relations between various countries

Sample questions: "What impact have multinational agribusiness companies had on the policies of some countries in Latin America?" "Why and how might a MNE seek to influence economic, labour, and/or environmental policies and regulations within a country?" "Why has the American government provided multi-billion dollar bailouts to banks and car companies?"

E3. Human Rights at Home and Abroad

FOCUS ON: *Political Significance; Stability and Change*

By the end of this course students will:

- E3.1** analyse some violations of human rights in Canada (*e.g., Chinese Head Taxes, internment of Japanese Canadians during World War II, residential school policies, segregation, laws that violated the rights of disabled people*) as well as the Canadian government's responses to violations of human rights, humanitarian crises, and genocides internationally (*e.g., the Holocaust, the Holodomor, apartheid in South Africa, the Rwandan genocide, the humanitarian crisis/genocide in Darfur*)

Sample questions: "What are some similarities and differences between government policies on Aboriginal rights and treaty issues in Canada and those in other countries such as Australia or New Zealand? What historical, political, social, and/or economic factors might account for any differences?" "What are some examples of a government's offering a public apology for past injustices? What are the reasons for such apologies? How meaningful or effective do you think such apologies are in addressing historical and/or continuing inequities?"

- E3.2** explain how various factors can either facilitate or limit the ability of the international community to intervene to prevent or mitigate violations of human rights (*e.g., with reference*

to economic, geographic, military, and/or cultural factors; public awareness and public opinion; political and public will)

Sample questions: “What are some reasons why North Atlantic Treaty Organization [NATO] or UN peacekeepers have been limited in their ability to intervene to prevent human rights violations in specific instances?” “Why might one country’s close economic or political ties with another lead it to ignore or respond in a rudimentary way to its partner state’s human rights violations?”

- E3.3** explain reasons for the success and failure of various Canadian and international agreements, institutions, and/or processes that were intended to protect human rights (*e.g., the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms; the Universal Declaration of Human Rights; the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples; the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights; Geneva Conventions; the UN Commission on Human Rights; the International Criminal Court [ICC]; the Stockholm Declaration*)

Sample questions: “Who has been successfully prosecuted by the ICC? What were the consequences of these convictions? Why are most war criminals not prosecuted by the ICC?” “What lessons were learned by the UN following its unsuccessful attempts to prevent the Rwandan genocide? What, if any, changes have resulted?” “Do all countries recognize the right to a healthy environment as a human right? If not, what impact might this have on the success of international environmental agreements?”

- E3.4** assess Canada’s ability to protect the rights and freedoms of Canadian citizens beyond Canada’s borders

Sample questions: “What human rights and freedoms can Canadian citizens travelling or working abroad expect to have acknowledged and protected under international human rights laws? How do these rights and freedoms compare with those guaranteed under the Canadian constitution, including the Charter of Rights and Freedoms?” “What responsibility does the Canadian government have to protect the human rights of Canadian citizens living, travelling, or working in a country with different human rights laws?”